

USA Marketplace — Payment & Logistics Choice

AOIN multi-vendor marketplace | Provider decision & rationale | July 2026

Context. AOIN is a **multi-vendor marketplace** (many sellers, one buyer checkout). The deciding factor is **not** the lowest per-transaction fee — it is whether the provider supports **marketplace split payments** and **multi-seller shipping**, because a marketplace pays out to many sellers and ships from many locations per order.

1. Payment Gateway → Stripe (Stripe Connect)

The choice

Use **Stripe** — specifically its marketplace product, **Stripe Connect**. PayPal as an optional secondary checkout button later.

Why Stripe (for a marketplace)

- **Split payments are native (Stripe Connect).** One buyer payment is automatically split to each seller's connected account, with AOIN's commission deducted — no manual payouts, no holding funds. This is the single most important marketplace requirement.
- **Handles seller onboarding & KYC/compliance.** Connect verifies each seller's identity and bank details (legally required to pay them). We don't build this from scratch.
- **Best developer API of any gateway** — fastest to integrate; supports subscriptions, Apple Pay, Google Pay.
- **We already have Stripe test keys** in the project, so groundwork exists.
- **Transparent pricing, no contract:** 2.9% + \$0.30 per transaction; no monthly/setup fee (Connect adds a small per-payout fee).

Why not the others

Gateway	Why not (for a US marketplace)
PayPal	Good as a <i>secondary</i> checkout button for conversion, but weaker for custom split-payout flows. Use alongside Stripe, not instead.
Square	Best when you also sell in person (POS). We're online-only, so its POS strength is wasted; less specialized for marketplace/subscription billing.
Authorize.Net	Adds a \$25/mo fee and a dated dashboard; better for businesses that already have their own merchant account. Not worth it early.
Adyen	Enterprise-only — heavy setup (€500–€5,000+), monthly platform fees, charges per authorization attempt (even failed). Only at very large scale (\$250K+/mo).

Verdict: Stripe Connect — the only mainstream US gateway purpose-built to split one payment across many sellers with automatic commission + seller KYC. Add PayPal as a secondary checkout option later to lift conversion.

2. Logistics / Shipping → EasyPost

The choice

Use **EasyPost** as the multi-carrier shipping API, with **USPS + UPS** enabled as the two carriers (add FedEx / a regional carrier later based on volume & geography).

Why EasyPost (for a marketplace, specifically)

- **Multi-seller / multi-pickup fits its model.** A marketplace order can hold items from several sellers, each shipping from their **own address** → one order becomes **multiple shipments**. EasyPost is API-native and built for this multi-origin routing.
- **Generous free volume: 3,000 labels/month free**, then \$0.08/label. With many sellers printing labels, this free ceiling matters more than a slightly lower per-label price.
- **Largest carrier network (100+ carriers)** and a 99.99% uptime SLA — any seller, any region, finds a carrier.
- **One integration, many carriers.** USPS (cheapest light parcels), UPS (heavier/B2B), FedEx (express), regional carriers — all just toggles inside EasyPost.

EasyPost vs Shippo (the close call)

	EasyPost (chosen)	Shippo
Free tier	3,000 labels/mo	30 labels/mo
Carriers	100+	40+
Built for	Custom apps / complex routing	Great too, slightly SMB-oriented
Per-label above free	\$0.08	\$0.05 (cheaper)

Shippo is **cheaper per label**, so if cost-per-label were the only axis, Shippo wins. But for a marketplace with **many sellers generating many labels**, EasyPost's **free 3,000/month** and **wider carrier coverage** outweigh the small per-label difference. (If volume stays low and cost-per-label is the priority, Shippo is a valid alternative.)

Carriers to enable inside EasyPost

- **USPS** — default/cheapest for light parcels (<5 lb); covers every US address incl. PO boxes & rural.
- **UPS** — secondary, for heavier / higher-value / B2B shipments.
- **FedEx / Regional (OnTrac, LSO, Veho)** — add later based on order weight/geography.

Verdict: EasyPost — its free 3,000 labels/month, 100+ carriers, and API-native multi-origin design make it the best fit for a marketplace where many sellers ship from many locations. Enable USPS + UPS first; expand carriers as volume grows.

Summary

Layer	Choose	One-line reason
Payments	Stripe (Connect)	Native split payments to many sellers + seller KYC + best API; PayPal secondary later.
Logistics	EasyPost (USPS + UPS)	Multi-seller/multi-pickup friendly, 3,000 free labels/mo, 100+ carriers, one API.

The rule behind both choices: for a marketplace, pick the provider that natively handles **many sellers** — split payouts on payments, multi-origin shipments on logistics — not just the one with the lowest headline fee.

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